

GONÇALO MOREIRA NEVES

Shaping culture and driving economic growth in Agri-Food Tech

Agri-Food Tech

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PROFILE

Horticultural lighting and CEA executive with 15+ years spanning photobiology research, LED product design, commercial leadership, and C-suite operations across Europe, Asia, and North America. Since August 2026, Managing Partner of APTA Advisory, an independent due diligence and business strategy firm for CEA and horticulture. An engineer at the core and a commercial leader in practice, with a proven record in value creation, capital raising, strategic partnerships, and technology integration.

Joined Lumatek Group (Lumatek and Photontek) as co-CEO with a commercial transformation and growth mandate: restructured operations, created two new customer segments, grew a key segment 210% in 2025 and lifted it to a 4x 2025 run-rate in Q1 2026, made the business data-driven, and left it growing and commercially self-sustaining. Previously grew Valoya from its first deal to €10M+ across 50+ countries; co-founded and exited Spectron Light Science (acquired in 14 months); contributed to Infarm's Series D (€200M, €1B+ valuation) and IGS's Series B (€50M, €200M+ valuation); and opened €20M+ in new revenue at IGS.

Published researcher in horticultural lighting (Burleigh Dodds, 2023). Member of the International Society for Horticultural Science. MSc in Illumination Engineering, Aalto University. Wageningen-certified in greenhouse and vertical farm lighting.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

Transformation & growth
Lumatek Group: restructured, repositioned and grown; left growing and commercially self-sustaining

Segment scale-up
Key segment +210% in 2025, then a 4x 2025 run-rate in Q1 2026 at Lumatek Group

2 new segments
Created at Lumatek Group; expanded the addressable market

~60% cost cut
Business cost-reduction strategy at Lumatek Group, with CFO, COO and CPO

€0 to €10M+
Valoya: first deal to scale across 50+ countries

€20M+ new revenue
IGS: two new revenue streams opened

Company exit
Co-founded Spectron Light Science; acquired in 14 months

Series D contribution
Infarm: €200M raised, €1B+ valuation

Series B contribution
IGS: €50M raised, €200M+ valuation

+73% output / m²
Infarm: technique and space optimisation

-40% energy / plant
Infarm: new HVAC design

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Managing Partner · APTA Advisory
Aug 2026 - Present · Lisbon, PT

Independent due diligence and business strategy firm for controlled-environment agriculture and horticulture (medical cannabis, floriculture, horticulture).

- Lead the firm and its service model: **CapEx and OpEx due diligence** for buyers of lighting, climate and automation systems, and business strategy for technology suppliers
- Advise shareholders and boards, procurement and operations teams, and business leaders on investment cases, supplier selection, unit economics and value creation
- Designed an **outcome-linked fee model** (share of verified savings, or fixed fee) that ties advisory fees to measured results
- Own go-to-market, pricing and partnerships; build the firm with partners and specialist contractors

co-CEO I Interim Chief of Sales & Marketing · Lumatek Group
Dec 2024 - Jul 2026 · Lisbon, PT

Led the commercial transformation and growth of Lumatek Group, a 20-year horticultural lighting manufacturer (HID and LED) with two brands, Lumatek and Photontek, and owned sales and marketing as interim CSO/CMO.

- Delivered a full commercial and cultural restructure: resized teams, closed underperforming markets, and opened new geographies and distribution channels
- **Created two new customer segments**, expanding the addressable market beyond legacy channels
- **Implemented a business cost-reduction strategy that cut overall costs by ~60%**, partnering with the CFO, COO and CPO
- **After growing the segment 210% in 2025, we reached a 4x 2025 run-rate in Q1 2026**, through targeted development and a repositioned product offer
- Transformed the business into a **data-driven organisation** and unified the commercial culture by breaking down internal silos between teams
- Supported the product development roadmap, bridging R&D and commercial requirements with a deep engineering background
- Left the business growing, commercially self-sustaining, and positioned for its next chapter

Independent Consultant · Gonçalo Neves Consulting
Apr 2024 - Aug 2026 · Lisbon, PT

Strategic and technical advisory to investors and operators in Agri-Food Tech and CEA (client details under NDA).

- Conducted technical due diligence on CEA companies, products, and technology platforms for investment decisions
- Delivered competitive market analyses: technology trends, regulatory landscape, market share, and consumer preferences
- Developed and implemented value-creation frameworks and KPI benchmarks for startups and scale-ups
- Advised on go-to-market strategy, pricing, and commercial team structure; delivered workshops and training on Agri-Food Tech

VP Business Development & Head of AgriTech Partnerships · IGS (Intelligent Growth Solutions)
Aug 2021 - Jul 2024 · Edinburgh / Amsterdam

Award-winning vertical farming technology company; IoT-enabled and AI-driven, built on six families of patents (IGS shareholder).

- **Contributed to raising Series B at €50M**, achieving a €200M+ company valuation
- Decreased product OpEx by up to 40% and CapEx/m² by up to 15% through partnership and process integration
- **Opened two new revenue streams generating €20M+** (vertical-farming/greenhouse hybrid; young-plant producers and seed/breeding)
- Closed strategic partnerships with Schneider Electric, Viscon Group, Microsoft, Plant Lighting, and Wageningen University & Research
- Built and led the business development team; ran teams for lean business-case development, IP acquisition, and partnerships; reported to the CEO and COO

Director of Farm Hardware · Infarm

Mar 2020 - Mar 2021 · Berlin, DE

Hardware leadership at one of Europe's highest-profile vertical farming scale-ups.

- **40% energy cost reduction per plant** via a new HVAC design; **61% rent cost reduction per m²** through technology integration; **+73% output per m²** via new growing techniques and space optimisation
- **Contributed to raising Series D at €200M, €1B+ valuation**
- Grew the team from ~40 to 100 people in one year; drove an **83% labour cost reduction per plant** through automation and new process workflow
- Created cross-functional teams (crops, hardware, software, digital PM) and led the move to SAFe, Agile, Kanban and Flight Levels; migrated hardware management to JIRA

Entrepreneurial Experience · Amsterdam, Netherlands

Jun 2016 - Jan 2020

Founded and led five ventures across AgriTech innovation, lighting design and manufacture, consultancy, and education.

> **Founder & CEO · Spectron Light Science** Nov 2016 - Dec 2017
> Designed and manufactured three horticultural LED product lines for vertical farming; the company was acquired by a major horticultural industry player.
>
> **Founder & CTO · OneFarm BV** Jan 2017 - Jan 2020
> Led technology strategy and product for large-scale vertical farm rollouts; raised a seed round (€1M, €5M+ valuation) and assisted in raising a Series A (€9M, €36M+ valuation).
>
> **Founder & CEO · BemStudio** Jun 2016 - May 2020
> Built and ran a Dutch engineering and business-consulting practice serving AgTech and CEA clients.
>
> **Director · A Lab Vertical Farm** Jun 2017 - Dec 2019
> Ran a community vertical farm and trained ~50 volunteers in controlled-environment agriculture and sustainable growing systems.
>
> **Guest Lecturer · Breitner Academie** Mar 2017 - Jun 2017
> Taught urban farming and food-technology innovation in the Technology Lab, combining theory with hands-on rapid prototyping.

Director of Business Development · Valoya

Jun 2011 - May 2016 · Helsinki, FI / NL

Leading photobiology-driven LED grow-light company. Rose through three roles over five years: Technical Manager, then Solution Manager, then Director of Business Development (joined as a minority shareholder).

- **Closed the company's first commercial deal (€300,000+) and grew revenue from €0 to €10M+**
- Developed and brought the company's first product lines to market
- **Expanded to 50+ countries** across Europe, Southeast Asia, Japan, and North America; opened the Amsterdam office
- Closed distribution partnerships in Japan and North America and managed distributor relations
- Identified new revenue streams (seed/breeding, research), repositioning on photobiology capability rather than raw efficiency metrics

Researcher · Aalto University

Apr 2009 - May 2011 · Helsinki, FI

- Researched horticultural lighting, vertical farming, and solid-state lighting: usage and control of LEDs, and the application of LEDs in plant cultivation
- Projects: SSHLighting, Solid-State Horticulture Lighting (2009-2011); LEDFlowers, LED Luminaire for Plant Cultivation (2008-2011)

CORE SKILLS

Leadership & strategy

Executive Leadership (CEO / co-CEO) · Interim C-Suite · Transformation & Change · Organisational Restructuring · Culture Change · P&L Ownership · Capital Raising · Board & Investor Relations

Commercial & growth

Business Development · Go-to-Market · Strategic Partnerships · Distribution & Channels · Pricing Strategy · Market Expansion · Customer Segmentation · Key Account Growth · Negotiation

Technical & product (CEA / lighting)

Horticultural LED Lighting · Spectrum / PPFD / DLI · Photobiology · Controlled Environment Agriculture · Vertical Farming · Greenhouse Technology · Hardware Product Development · Illumination & Electrical Engineering · HVAC (CEA) · IoT, Automation & Robotics

AI, data & tools

Generative AI for Business · ChatGPT · Perplexity · Data-Driven Decision-Making · BI & Analytics (Tableau) · ERP Systems · CRM (HubSpot, Salesforce) · Project Management (JIRA, Asana, Monday, Confluence) · Agile / SAFe / Flight Levels / Kanban · Microsoft 365 · Google Workspace

EDUCATION

M.Sc.(Tech.) Electrical Engineering
Illumination Engineering & Electrical Building Services, Aalto University, Finland (2010-2012)

M.Sc.(Minor) International Design Business Management
Aalto University, Finland (2011-2012)

B.Sc.(Tech.) Electromechanical Engineering
Universidade da Beira Interior, Portugal (2004-2009)

B.Sc. Erasmus Exchange, Electromechanical Engineering
Teknillinen korkeakoulu (now Aalto), Finland (2009)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Lighting in Greenhouses & Vertical Farms, Wageningen University & Research (2018)
- Leading SAFe, Gladwell Academy
- Agile for Hardware, Gladwell Academy
- Flight Levels, Flight Levels Academy
- Product Development Project, Design Factory, Aalto University
- Mental Health First Aider, Worksafe (UK) Ltd

PUBLICATIONS

- **Advances in Plant Factories: New Technologies in Indoor Vertical Farming** (Part 6, Ch. 20), Burleigh Dodds Science Publishing, Eds. Dr Toyoki Kozai & Dr Eri Hayashi
  Co-Author · 2023
- **Lighting Units and Measurements in Plant Cultivation**, Aalto University
  Author · 2014
- **Valotusta tarpeen mukaan**, real-time dynamic lighting in cultivation, Int'l Review of Civil Engineering
  Co-Author · 2011

MEMBERSHIPS

- Member, International Society for Horticultural Science (ISHS); contributing to standard units and measurements for horticultural lighting

LANGUAGES

Portuguese	Native
English	Full professional
Spanish	Advanced
French	Basic
Finnish	Beginner

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